English • Satire, narration and dramatic craft

The Dear Departed

One-act play • Complete official activities • Review 2 • Health supplement • Script writing

Unit 11 • One-act play • Includes Review 2 and Supplementary Health Activities

Play at a glance

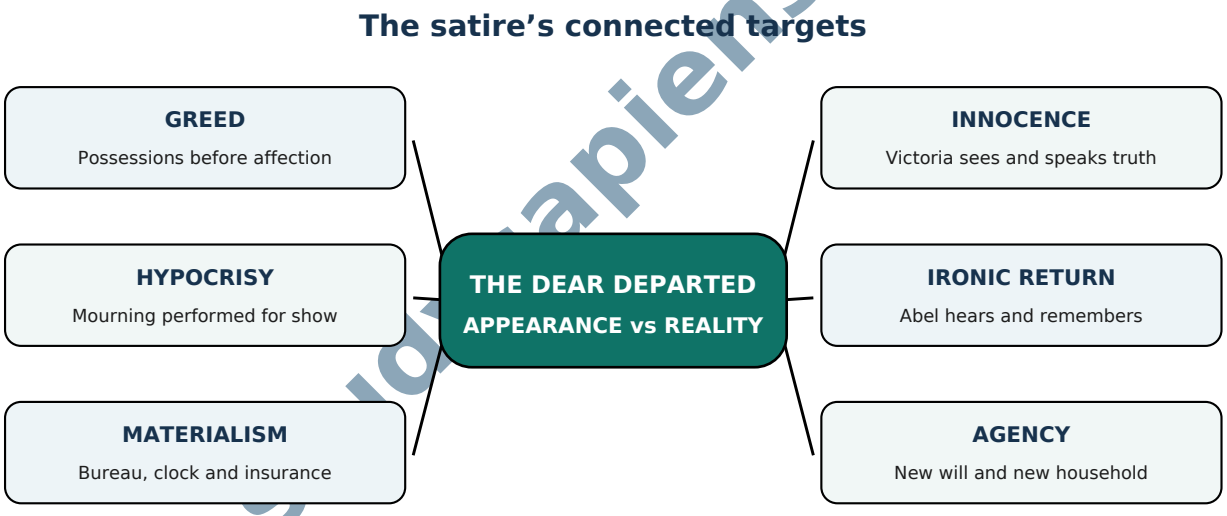
• **Playwright:** William Stanley Houghton (1881–1913), associated with the Manchester School of realistic, socially conscious drama; *The Dear Departed* was written in 1908.

• **Form:** A single-setting prose satire in one act, using dark humour, stage directions and rapid reversals to expose middle-class hypocrisy.

• **Central conflict:** Two daughters and their husbands begin dividing Abel Merryweather's possessions while he is believed dead, only for him to return and discover their motives.

• **Language focus:** Character and plot, connotation, word families, direct/indirect narration, oral performance and play-script conventions.

Figure 1 — Original thematic map of Houghton's satire



Main idea in the centre → supporting details → examples → a clear concluding sentence

Appendices included: The official Review 2 for Units 7–11 and the supplementary dengue/coronavirus reading activities follow the play section, preserving the one-PDF-per-unit package structure.

Pre-Reading, Characters and Setting

P1. Will the tone be serious or humorous? Why?

The subject of death initially suggests seriousness, but the title's euphemistic politeness and the family's rivalry over possessions point towards dark humour. The play treats greed and hypocrisy seriously while exposing them through absurd haste, contradictory speeches, comic stage directions and an unexpected return.

Setting 1. How is the room arranged?

The modest Edwardian living room has a central dining table and chairs, a sofa, practical side furniture and a staircase at the back. A mantelpiece holds the clock, while framed photographs, subdued colours and slightly worn furnishings reinforce an ordinary middle-class home. Doors allow entrances and the final exit; the upstairs room contains Abel and the contested bureau.

Setting 2. What does the room look and feel like?

Brown, cream and grey tones, soft light and functional furniture create a restrained, apparently mournful atmosphere. This respectability is deceptive: the confined, intimate room soon becomes a space where whispered accusations and greedy behaviour replace the outward calm.

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Character	Relationship and dramatic function
Mrs. Amelia Slater	Abel's elder daughter, Henry's wife and Victoria's mother; domineering, acquisitive and highly concerned with appearances.
Henry Slater	Amelia's husband and Victoria's father; hesitant and sometimes sensitive to propriety, but too compliant to stop the theft.
Mrs. Elizabeth Jordan	Abel's other daughter, Ben's wife and Amelia's sister; sharp, self-righteous and equally motivated by inheritance.
Ben Jordan	Elizabeth's husband; humorous and sociable, but drawn into the same disputes and evasions.
Victoria Slater	Amelia and Henry's daughter and Abel's granddaughter; observant, candid and the only person openly delighted that Abel is alive.

Character	Relationship and dramatic function
Abel Merryweather	The supposedly dead father; vigorous, blunt and witty, he converts discovery of their conduct into a new will and a new life.

One-act feature	How the play demonstrates it
Single continuous act	The action unfolds without a change of act.
Focused plot	The presumed death, inheritance dispute and return dominate every scene.
Limited characters	Six speaking figures allow quick recognition of family relationships.
Single setting	The Slaters' living room concentrates confrontation and stage business.
Quick pace	Possessions are moved before the relatives arrive; discoveries and reversals follow rapidly.
Central theme	Materialism and hypocrisy are exposed through one compact social situation.

Plot and Character Development

Stage	Events and effect
Exposition	The Slaters prepare mourning and discuss Abel's supposed death; Victoria is told to change out of colours.
Rising action	Amelia gives Henry Abel's slippers and moves the bureau and clock downstairs. The Jordans arrive, mourning is compared and inheritance and insurance dominate conversation.
Turning point / climax	Victoria reports that Abel is getting up. He enters alive, recognizes his possessions and learns that he had been presumed dead.

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Stage	Events and effect
Falling action	Abel announces a new will favouring the person with whom he lives. The sisters compete for him and expose that neither previously wanted the responsibility.
Resolution	Abel rejects their opportunism: he will alter the will, pay the premium and marry Mrs. John Shorrocks. He leaves, taking satisfaction that the bureau is already downstairs for removal.

Concise play summary

• Believing Abel Merryweather dead, Amelia Slater and Henry move his bureau and clock downstairs and use his slippers before Elizabeth and Ben Jordan arrive. The adults perform mourning while discussing obituary wording, furniture, a gold watch and an insurance premium. Victoria then discovers that Abel is alive. His return exposes the moved property and the relatives' contradictory claims. When Abel proposes leaving his possessions to the person caring for him at his death, both daughters suddenly offer him a home and reveal their earlier reluctance to keep him. Abel instead announces a new will and marriage to Mrs. John Shorrocks, choosing a household where he believes he will be welcomed.

Reading and Critical Thinking

A. Answer the following questions.

1. What do Mrs. Slater's and Mrs. Jordan's words and actions reveal about their motivations?

Amelia's immediate seizure of the slippers, bureau and clock shows acquisitiveness beneath her professed heartbreak. Elizabeth condemns her sister but arrives in new mourning, claims the watch for Jimmy and competes for Abel after the new will is announced. Their behaviour is therefore self-interested rather than guided by grief or duty. Each criticizes in the other what she also does herself.

2. How does the conflict over possessions drive the plot, and what values does it reveal?

The moved bureau creates the first deception, the slippers supply comic evidence and the insurance discussion intensifies suspicion. Abel's recognition of the bureau and clock exposes the scheme, while his new will triggers the final contest between the sisters. Possessions thus cause every major reversal and reveal that property and social appearance rank above honesty, care and family loyalty.

3. How does Houghton use satire to criticize family and social values, and is it effective?

He exaggerates hasty mourning, inappropriate remarks, competitive obituary language and theft carried out under sentimental speeches. The ridiculous "mourning brother" lie and Abel's dry replies make the adults condemn themselves. Satire is effective because laughter lowers the audience's defensive response while the unmistakable gap between words and actions delivers a serious moral judgement.

4. How does the play challenge traditional family unity and affection?

The family gathers not to comfort one another but to calculate shares. Long-standing resentment surfaces when the sisters admit that neither wanted Abel, and their new affection depends entirely on his will. The play suggests that kinship alone does not guarantee love: relationships become transactional when material reward determines attention and respect.

5. What role and symbolism does the mantelpiece clock have?

Literally, it is a valuable object Amelia takes before the division. Symbolically, it represents time and routine reduced to inheritable property; the family is concerned with what remains after Abel rather than with his living time. When it strikes six, it helps Abel recognize the theft, turning a claimed possession into evidence against the claimants.

6. How does Victoria differ from the adults, and what does her perspective suggest?

Victoria asks direct questions, notices where Abel actually went and fears entering his room, but she speaks the crucial truth that he is getting up. Her spontaneous joy contrasts with her mother's angry whisper. She represents an observant younger generation capable of recognizing adult pretence, although her elders repeatedly instruct her to remain silent.

7. How do the characters display hypocrisy? Give examples.

Amelia claims to be heartbroken while preventing waste of slippers and stealing furniture. Elizabeth calls the conduct indelicate yet seeks her own share and later welcomes Abel for his money. The adults discuss refined obituary sentiments while insulting Abel, and they invent a dead brother to explain mourning. Their public morality consistently contradicts their private behaviour.

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8. How does the single confined living room affect interaction and relationships?

The limited space keeps every character close to the evidence: slippers, bureau, clock and mourning clothes cannot be hidden indefinitely. Stage business becomes visible to everyone, so evasions quickly produce confrontation. The room resembles a pressure chamber, suggesting that the family's apparent closeness is actually confinement created by resentment, surveillance and competing claims.

9. How does the sequence of events build tension and expose motives?

Houghton first establishes the death assumption, then lets the audience watch theft before the other relatives arrive. Delays over tea and insurance postpone discovery while revealing greed. Victoria's announcement reverses the situation, but Abel's gradual recognition sustains suspense. Only after the new will is proposed do the sisters' final offers expose their motives completely, preparing his unexpected marriage decision.

10. Why do the themes remain relevant? Give contemporary examples.

Families may still compete over property, digital accounts, businesses or care responsibilities before an elderly person's wishes are known. Social media can also make public mourning more performative than private support. A modern equivalent would be relatives posting affectionate tributes while arguing over a house or avoiding everyday care. The play therefore remains a warning against confusing image and inheritance with love.

B. Choose the correct option.

Q	Answer
1	(b) They value material wealth over family bonds.
2	(b) The single room creates an intimate space where true natures are revealed.
3	(c) Victoria's confusion and direct responses suggest innocence compared with adult greed.
4	(b) Satire humorously criticizes hypocrisy and greed.
5	(a) The clock can symbolize passing time and routine in family life.

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C. Discuss the one-act play with the Unit 6 plot diagram.

Use the five-stage diagram above. The exposition establishes presumed death; rising action centres on claims; the climax is Abel's return; falling action exposes the sisters' self-interest through the will; and the resolution transfers Abel's future away from them. The compact setting makes every stage immediately consequential.

Vocabulary and Word Families

A. Denotation and connotation.

Word	Denotation	Connotation in the play
precocious	developed in ability or behaviour earlier than usual	Victoria's sharp observation; can also imply disapproval of being too forward
gallivanting	going from place to place for enjoyment	parental scolding and alleged irresponsibility, not innocent play in the speaker's view
speck	a very small spot or particle	extreme scrutiny and petty respectability
bureau	a writing desk with drawers	desirability, status and greed rather than practical use
impassive	showing little emotion	Elizabeth's irritating self-satisfaction and emotional coldness
hearth	the floor or area at the base of a fireplace	home and warmth, ironically contrasting with the family's cold conduct

B. Choose the correct antonyms.

1. shabby → elegant (b)

2. impassive → expressive (d)

3. delicate → robust (d; "tough" can work in some contexts, but robust is the strongest opposite of physically delicate)

4. precocious → belated (d)

5. heartiness → indifference (a)

C. Build word families from the root words.

Root	Valid related forms
colour	coloured, colourful, colourless, colouring, discolour, discolouration
count	countable, countless, counting, recount, recounted, miscount
play	player, playful, playfully, playfulness, replay, playwright, playground
work	worker, workable, working, rework, workshop, workload, workplace
faith	faithful, faithfully, faithfulness, faithless, unfaithful, unfaithfully

Direct and Indirect Narration

A. Change the narration of items 1–17.

Item	Answer
1	My father advised me never to cheat anyone.
2	My friend suggested that we should watch a documentary. / My friend suggested watching a documentary.
3	The captain angrily ordered the soldier always to obey his seniors.
4	My mother prayed for my prosperity.
5	He said that he had not gone to school the previous day.
6	The officer ordered that the next visitor should be called.
7	The teacher asked whose pen it was.
8	She asked me what I was looking for.
9	Zeeshaan exclaimed sorrowfully that he had failed the examination.
10	He asked where I was going.
11	He requested me to excuse him because he was too tired to go to the market.

Item	Answer
12	She told me to listen and asked whether I could hear someone coming.
13	Our teacher said that the sun rises in the east. (Universal truth: no tense change.)
14	He said to his teacher, “Please explain that theory again.”
15	He said to them, “You played well.”
16	He said to me, “Good morning.”
17	He asked me when I would have completed my work.

B. Convert the explanatory passage into direct speech.

Direct-speech version

• The father said to his daughter, “The internet has many useful applications. You can use it for educational purposes, such as researching information for school projects and accessing online courses. It is also a valuable tool for communication because people can stay in touch with friends and family through emails and social media.

• “However, you must use the internet responsibly. Be cautious about sharing personal information. You should balance your internet use with other activities, such as reading books, playing outside and spending time with family.”

Oral Communication Skills

A. Group discussion of an assigned section.

Model presentation — The bureau and clock are discovered

• **Main conflict:** Abel gradually discovers that his property was moved while he was believed dead.

• **Revealing details:** Henry wears the slippers; the bureau stands downstairs; the clock strikes six; Elizabeth calls the act robbery; and Amelia’s earlier correction from “bureau” to “chest of drawers” anticipates her exposure.

• **Interpretation:** Physical objects provide more reliable evidence than the relatives’ sentimental language. The scene converts private greed into public knowledge and makes Abel’s later decision believable.

B(i). Research the playwright and social background.

Short research presentation

• William Stanley Houghton (1881–1913) was an English playwright associated with the Manchester School of realistic drama. His short career produced socially conscious works marked by sharp wit, including *Hindle Wakes* and *The Dear Departed* (1908). The Edwardian middle-class setting helps explain the play's attention to respectable clothing, polished obituary language, insurance and furniture.

• The unit does not identify a specific autobiographical incident that inspired the play, so one should not invent one. It is safer to say that Houghton uses a familiar inheritance dispute to satirize materialism and hypocrisy. His realism makes the living room and ordinary possessions vehicles for broader social criticism.

B(ii–iii). Narrate and perform key moments.

Model role-play: Abel returns

• **[Victoria stands near the door, breathless. The adults freeze. Abel enters in a faded dressing-gown.]**

VICTORIA: "Grandpa, I'm so glad you're not dead!"

MRS. SLATER: *(whispering fiercely)* "Hold your tongue, Victoria."

ABEL: *(looking from one black outfit to another)* "Who's gone dead?"

BEN: *(avoiding Abel's eyes)* "A … relative of mine."

ABEL: *(dryly)* "Indeed? And what was his name?"

• **Performance note:** Victoria should sound relieved, Mrs. Slater controlled and alarmed, and Abel curious rather than immediately furious. Ben's pause creates comedy. The audience should notice who moves away from Abel and who moves towards him.

C. Enact the one-act play in class.

Rehearsal block	Performance focus
Opening to furniture removal	Fast, practical movement; sentimental lines contrast with self-interested action.
Arrival and insurance discussion	Formal mourning poses, suspicious looks and increasing self-interest.
Victoria's announcement and Abel's entrance	A genuine pause before the reveal; distinct reactions from every actor.
Discovery and new will	Abel's controlled recognition followed by the sisters' transparent competition.
Final decision and exit	Abel's confident timing; end on the bureau remark so the irony lands clearly.

D. What role does humour play in the play?

Humour exposes rather than cancels the seriousness. Mourning contests, invented relatives, misuse of slippers and Abel’s dry observations make greed ridiculous. Because the audience laughs at contradictions, it recognizes hypocrisy without needing a narrator to lecture. The final joke about the bureau also completes Abel’s practical victory.

E. Can any part be related to family relationships or social expectations?

Model reflection: People sometimes feel pressure to appear generous or respectful in public while avoiding everyday responsibilities. A family may praise an elderly relative at gatherings yet leave routine care to one person. The play encourages me to measure affection by consistent action and honest communication rather than by ceremonies, appearances or expectations of reward.

Writing Skills: Play Mechanics and Director’s Notes

A. Identify the mechanics in the supplied excerpt.

Mechanic	Function in the excerpt
Character names + colon	Show who speaks and separate name from dialogue.
Bracketed stage directions	Guide movement, expression, pauses and tone without turning them into spoken lines.
Punctuation	Questions create challenge; pauses and full stops control pace; exclamation marks sharpen conflict.
Dialogue and subtext	Henry’s conciliatory words contrast with the sisters’ accusations, revealing unease and subtext.
Scene description	Establishes place, characters and immediate action before dialogue begins.

Original short scene — The Empty Seat

• **[A school hall. A laptop and three cue cards lie on a table. MIRA moves a chair while ALI checks the programme. SARA enters slowly.]**
• **MIRA:** *(brightly)* “Everything is ready. We only need our fourth speaker.”
ALI: “Sara? You were supposed to bring the final slide.”
SARA: *(holding out a printed sheet)* “I had it … but the file would not open.”
MIRA: *(pausing, then taking a breath)* “Then we solve that instead of blaming you. Ali, check the printed copy.”
ALI: *(nodding)* “I can read the figures aloud.”
SARA: “And I can explain the diagram.”
MIRA: “Good. We enter together … and no one has to face the audience alone.”

B. Write 15–20+ lines with at least three distinct characters and director’s notes.

Original dialogue — The Project Decision

• **[The classroom after school. A model bridge lies in two pieces on the table. HINA stands with her arms folded. OMAR searches a toolbox. RABIA holds a notebook.]**
• **HINA:** *(impatiently)* “We cannot submit this tomorrow. It broke again!”
• **OMAR:** *(calmly)* “Then we stop adding decoration and strengthen the base.”
• **RABIA:** *(opening her notebook)* “The first design had a wider base. Perhaps we should return to it.”
• **HINA:** “But the tall tower was my idea. It looked impressive.”
• **OMAR:** “It did … until it leaned.” *(He smiles gently, not mockingly.)*
• **RABIA:** “Could we keep a smaller tower above the stronger base?”
• **[The door opens. Their teacher, MS. KIRAN, enters and examines the model.]**
• **MS. KIRAN:** “What does the test evidence tell you?”
• **HINA:** *(looking down)* “That appearance alone will not make it stable.”
• **OMAR:** “We have enough cardboard for two triangular supports.”
• **RABIA:** “I will record the changes and test each one for thirty seconds.”
• **MS. KIRAN:** “Good. Who explains which part during the presentation?”
• **HINA:** “Omar will explain the base, Rabia the results … and I will explain what we learned from the failed design.”
• **OMAR:** *(lifting the supports)* “Then let us begin before the glue dries.”
• **RABIA:** *(writing)* “Decision recorded: stronger base, smaller tower, three tests.”
• **MS. KIRAN:** “That is teamwork: a clear decision, shared roles and evidence.”
• **[HINA picks up the smaller tower while the others steady the base. The three exchange relieved smiles.]**
• **HINA:** “Next time, we test first … and admire later.”

Peer-review checklist: Names are consistent; each speaker has a distinct attitude; brackets show setting and action; punctuation shapes delivery; the conflict changes through evidence; and the final line resolves the decision without an explanatory essay.

Review 2 • Units 7–11

This appendix solves the official cumulative review placed after Unit 11. Models remain concise where the relevant unit contains a fuller answer.

Reading A. Answer the cumulative questions.

1. Is the advice in “If” relevant today? Why or why not?

Yes. Online criticism, academic pressure, rapid career change and economic uncertainty make calm judgement and resilience especially valuable. Balanced self-trust helps people evaluate criticism without becoming dependent on approval, while humility and truthful conduct remain essential. The advice needs a healthy interpretation: perseverance should not mean ignoring injury, injustice or the need for support.

2. How has globalisation spread cultural practices? Give examples.

Migration, trade, tourism, film, social media and digital education allow languages, food, fashion, music and celebrations to travel. Pakistani clothing and cuisine can reach international audiences, while people in Pakistan encounter foreign entertainment and learning resources. Such exchange can increase appreciation, but local creators need visibility if diversity is to survive alongside global trends.

3. What problems face snow leopards and markhors, and how effective are the solutions?

Poaching, habitat loss, climate pressures and livestock-related retaliation threaten them. Community conservation, regulated revenue programmes, compensation, predator-proof enclosures and awareness can reduce these pressures. The text reports improvement, but effectiveness depends on independent monitoring, fair benefits and habitat protection; a single programme cannot guarantee recovery everywhere.

4. What does “The Dear Departed” suggest, and why is it ironic?

The title resembles a respectful obituary phrase for a beloved dead person. It is ironic because Abel is alive and returns, and because his relatives’ conduct shows that property matters more to them than his company. Only Victoria displays uncomplicated joy, exposing the emptiness of the adults’ affectionate language.

5. How does humour convey family conflict and hypocrisy?

Houghton uses comic haste, absurd lies, inappropriate remarks and revealing stage business. Mourning becomes a fashion contest, Henry wears the supposed dead man’s slippers and the relatives cannot agree on an invented brother. These contradictions make the audience laugh while demonstrating the painful breakdown of sincerity and care.

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Vocabulary A. Dictionary pronunciation, meaning and part of speech.

Word / pronunciation	Dictionary meaning	Part of speech
globalisation /ˌgləʊbəlaɪˈzeɪʃən/	increasing interconnection of economies, cultures and societies worldwide	noun
crucial /ˈkruːʃəl/	extremely important; decisive	adjective
population /ˌpɒpjʊˈleɪʃən/	all the people or animals living in an area; their number	noun
sustainable /səˈsteɪnəbəl/	able to continue without exhausting resources or causing serious long-term harm	adjective
departed /dɪˈpɑːtɪd/	dead (in the title); also left or gone as the past form of depart	adjective; verb

Vocabulary B. Use each commonly confused pair in original sentences.

Pair	Model sentences
compliment / complement	She **complimented** my clear explanation. / The green cushions **complement** the curtains.
eligible / illegible	Only eligible candidates may apply. / His handwriting was almost illegible.
foul / fowl	The foul smell drove us outside. / The farmer keeps several kinds of fowl.
gentle / genteel	Her gentle voice reassured the child. / The genteel guests observed every formal custom.
respectable / respectful	He runs a respectable business. / We must remain respectful during disagreement.
wander / wonder	We wandered through the old market. / I wonder whether the museum is open.
yoke / yolk	The oxen were joined by a wooden yoke. / The yolk turned golden when cooked.

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Vocabulary C. Root-word families (repeated from the play activity).

Root	Related words
colour	coloured, colourful, colourless, colouring, discolour, discolouration
count	countable, countless, counting, recount, recounted, miscount
play	player, playful, playfully, playfulness, replay, playwright, playground
work	worker, workable, working, rework, workshop, workload, workplace
faith	faithful, faithfully, faithfulness, faithless, unfaithful, unfaithfully

Grammar A. Choose the appropriate conjunctions.

1. We can go to the beach **or** we can visit the museum.

2. He missed the bus **because** he woke up late.

3. **Until** you finish your homework, you cannot go outside.

4. Neither Ali **nor** his sister wanted to join the game.

5. She is tired, **but** she kept working until midnight.

Grammar B. Identify simple or complex sentences and explain.

Sentence	Classification
The cat sat on the windowsill and watched the birds.	Simple — one subject and a compound predicate; no dependent clause.
Even though it was raining, the children continued to play outside.	Complex — dependent concessive clause + independent clause.
He finished his homework before dinner.	Simple — “before dinner” is a prepositional phrase, not a clause.
Because she studied hard, Maria passed the exam with flying colours.	Complex — dependent reason clause + independent clause.
The sun set behind the mountains.	Simple — one independent clause.

Grammar C. Change direct speech to indirect speech.

1. Sarah said that she was going to the market.

2. The teacher asked the student whether he or she had completed his or her homework.

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3. Tahir said that he would finish his project by the next day.

4. She exclaimed that the painting was very beautiful.

5. Javed asked when they were leaving for the trip.

Oral A. Teacher–student direct/indirect speech practice.

Model interaction and conversion

• **Teacher:** “Did you complete your homework?”
Student: “Yes, I finished it last night.”
Reported: The student said that he/she had finished it the previous night.
• **Teacher:** “What was the most challenging part?”
Student: “I found the mathematics problems difficult.”
Reported: The student said that he/she had found the mathematics problems difficult.
• **Teacher:** “When are you planning to submit your project?”
Student: “I will submit it by the end of the week.”
Reported: The student said that he/she would submit it by the end of that week.
• **Teacher:** “Have you studied for the upcoming test?”
Student: “I am planning to study tonight.”
Reported: The student said that he/she was planning to study that night.

Oral B. One-minute SDG speech.

Goal 13: Climate Action

• Climate Action matters because floods, heatwaves and shifting rainfall already affect health, livelihoods and education. Students can contribute by saving energy, reducing waste and supporting accurate environmental information, but individual action is not enough. Schools and local governments should improve emergency planning, protect trees and include climate science in practical learning. My request is simple: measure our school’s resource use, choose one achievable reduction and review the result each term. Climate action becomes meaningful when good intentions turn into measurable, shared responsibility.

Oral C. Wildlife Vignette: share a short experience-based story.

Original model vignette — The Watchful Evening

• During a community nature walk, our group noticed a shepherd moving goats away from a rocky path after a wildlife volunteer warned of nearby predator activity. At first, I expected the shepherd to be angry. Instead, he described a new strengthened enclosure and explained that fewer night attacks had made him less fearful. I realized that conservation was not a contest between people and animals. Safer livestock management had created room for both livelihoods and wildlife, and our role was to listen rather than approach or photograph the animals.

Oral D. Discuss the play's message about human relationships.

Model group conclusion

• The play argues that affection cannot be proved by formal clothing, public praise or sudden attention when money is expected. Healthy relationships require honest speech, everyday care and respect for an elderly person's autonomy. Abel's decision also reminds the audience that people should not be treated as burdens or property-owning opportunities. A fair family discussion about care and inheritance should happen openly before crisis or loss.

Writing A. Paraphrase the opening lines of "If".

Opening-lines paraphrase

• Remain calm and think clearly when the people around you are panicking and trying to hold you responsible for their own loss of control.

Writing B. Brainstorm, mind-map and draft a descriptive composition on quality education.

Mind-map branch	Brainstormed details
Meaning	Effective learning, knowledge, values, practical skills and lifelong curiosity
Key elements	Supported teachers, relevant curriculum, safe inclusive classrooms, useful resources and feedback
Benefits	Confidence, employment, innovation, equality, health and responsible citizenship
Challenges	Poverty, overcrowding, outdated methods, inadequate training and unequal technology
Solutions	Teacher development, targeted support, curriculum reform, safe access and measurable review

Model composition — What Makes Education “Quality”?

• Quality education is one of the strongest foundations for personal fulfilment and social progress. It is more than enrolment or the memorization of facts: it enables learners to understand ideas, apply skills, act responsibly and continue learning as circumstances change.

• Several elements make this possible. Trained and supported teachers recognize different learning needs and give constructive feedback. An engaging curriculum connects essential knowledge with real problems, while a safe and inclusive classroom allows every learner to participate. Books, laboratories and suitable digital resources enrich lessons, but they are effective only when guided by clear teaching and fair access.

• The benefits extend beyond the individual. Literacy, numeracy, vocational ability and critical thinking create employment and innovation. Education also strengthens health choices, equality and responsible citizenship. In a community, confident learners can become mentors, entrepreneurs and informed decision-makers, sharing opportunities rather than keeping progress to themselves.

• Important challenges remain. Poverty can interrupt attendance, overcrowded classrooms can limit attention, and outdated methods can leave students unprepared for practical life. Teacher shortages and unequal technology deepen these difficulties. Solutions include professional development, targeted scholarships, smaller support groups, relevant curricula and reliable offline as well as digital materials.

• Improving quality therefore requires sustained cooperation among learners, families, teachers and institutions. Progress should be judged not only by buildings or examination totals but by whether every student learns safely and develops usable abilities. A society that invests in such education invests in its own future.

Writing C. Write a well-structured paragraph on “My Service to Society”.

Model paragraph

• I can serve society by combining consistent study with practical help in my neighbourhood. I will first offer a weekly reading session to a younger student who needs support, because patient encouragement can improve both confidence and learning. In addition, I will join a monthly clean-up, avoid wasting water and persuade my family to separate recyclable material. When someone shares false health or community information, I will check reliable sources before repeating it. These actions may appear small, but regular service builds responsible habits and strengthens trust. My aim is not praise; it is to leave people and places slightly better through honest, sustained effort.

Supplementary Health Reading • Dengue

Medical-source alert: This is a solved educational appendix, not clinical advice. The source's blanket statement that no effective dengue vaccines are available is no longer universally accurate: vaccine availability and eligibility vary by country and patient history. Testing, treatment and public-health rules should be checked with a qualified clinician and current local guidance.

Topic	Accurate study notes
Cause and vector	Dengue is a viral infection transmitted mainly through the bite of infected female *Aedes* mosquitoes; the female takes blood needed for egg development.
Life cycle	Egg → larva → pupa → adult. Eggs hatch into feeding larvae, followed by a non-feeding pupal stage from which the adult emerges.
Common symptoms	High fever, chills, headache, pain behind the eyes, muscle and joint pain, and sometimes red eyes or rash.
Diagnosis	CBC can support assessment and monitoring, especially platelet and blood-concentration changes, but appropriate clinical evaluation and specific tests are needed for diagnosis.
Core prevention	Reduce mosquito breeding and bites through water-container management, suitable clothing, labelled repellent, screens/nets and coordinated community action.

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Exercise. Give short answers.

1. What measures control mosquito propagation?

Empty, scrub and cover water-storage containers regularly; discard unused tyres, cups and packaging; clean coolers, trays, tanks and drains; and remove rubbish where water can collect. Natural and artificial water-holding sites should be inspected. Community larviciding or fogging should be conducted by trained personnel with safety precautions, not used as a substitute for source reduction.

2. How can we protect ourselves from mosquito bites?

Wear covering clothing, use an approved repellent according to its label, keep windows and doors screened where possible and use suitable nets, including insecticide-treated nets when advised. Repair gaps and reduce mosquitoes around the home. Because Aedes mosquitoes can bite during daylight, protection should not be limited to sleeping hours.

3. Name various mosquito breeding sites.

Aedes can breed in small collections of clean water in tree holes, bamboo and leaves, as well as in bottles, cups, food packaging, tyres, buckets, barrels, jars, coolers, painting trays, toys, damaged appliances, tanks and broken surfaces. The common feature is standing water, not whether the container is natural or artificial.

4. What should a student’s role in dengue control be?

Students can inspect safe areas with an adult, identify and report standing water, remind families to cover containers and share reliable prevention messages at school and home. They can prepare posters or a local breeding-site map and should not handle insecticides or enter unsafe locations.

5. What are common dengue symptoms?

Common symptoms include sudden high fever, chills, headache, pain behind the eyes, aching muscles and joints, red eyes and rash. Some people also experience nausea or weakness. Warning signs such as severe abdominal pain, persistent vomiting, bleeding, marked drowsiness or rapid worsening require urgent medical attention.

6. How can a dengue patient be managed at home?

Home care is appropriate only for a person assessed as stable by a clinician. Rest and adequate fluids are important, and medicines should be used only as professionally directed. Paracetamol is commonly used for fever under guidance; aspirin and ibuprofen/Brufen should be avoided because they can increase bleeding risk. Return urgently for any warning sign rather than continuing home care.

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Activity 1. Group survey of breeding sites.

Safe example location	Risk identified	Action and follow-up
School plant saucer	Standing water after watering	Empty and scrub with staff permission; check after two days.
Home water barrel	Loose or missing cover	Ask an adult to fit a secure cover; inspect weekly.

Safe example location	Risk identified	Action and follow-up
Neighbourhood discarded cup	Rainwater collection	Report to responsible adult or local team; do not enter private property.
Classroom cooler tray	Water accumulated during cleaning	Ask staff to drain and dry it; record the follow-up date.

Activity 2. Group discussion on dengue control.

Model group conclusion

• Our group recommends a repeated cycle of inspect, remove, cover and educate. Individual protection reduces bites, but neighbourhood source reduction addresses breeding before mosquitoes multiply. Posters should name concrete actions and inspection days rather than merely saying “avoid dengue”. Any spraying should remain the responsibility of trained personnel, and people with possible dengue symptoms should seek appropriate medical advice.

Supplementary Health Reading • Coronavirus

Current-guidance warning: The printed 14-day rule reflects an earlier COVID-19 period. Isolation, quarantine and testing recommendations have changed over time and may differ by location and risk. Follow current public-health instructions. Seek emergency care for severe breathing difficulty, confusion, bluish lips/face or other urgent warning signs.

Term	Meaning in the supplement
Quarantine	Separating or restricting movement after a possible exposure to see whether illness develops.
Isolation	Separating a person known or believed to be infected, even when symptoms are absent.
Home care principles	Use current instructions; improve ventilation, reduce shared items and close contact, clean hands and use a well-fitting mask when contact is necessary and recommended.
Nutrition	Balanced meals, fruits, vegetables, whole grains, suitable protein, unsaturated fats and water support general recovery; no single food or vitamin cures COVID-19.

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Term	Meaning in the supplement
Supplements	Vitamin D or other supplements should not be presented as a cure or substitute for vaccination, testing or treatment; use them only with appropriate professional advice.

Exercise. Seven-day general menu for an adult in self-quarantine.

This sample assumes an adult with no allergies or special medical diet. Adjust portions and choices for age, health conditions, culture and availability; drink water regularly. It is general nutrition guidance, not COVID-19 treatment.

Day	Breakfast	Mid-morning	Lunch	Evening	Dinner
Mon	Oats, milk, banana	Apple	Rice, chicken, vegetables	Yoghurt, almonds	Daal, chapati, salad
Tue	Egg, wholegrain toast, milk	Orange	Daal, rice, salad	Fruit	Vegetable and chicken soup, toast
Wed	Whole-wheat paratha, yoghurt	Banana	Chickpea curry, chapati	A few nuts	Fish, rice, vegetables
Thu	Yoghurt, oats, seasonal fruit	Guava	Chicken pulao, salad	Milk	Lentil soup, wholegrain toast
Fri	Vegetable omelette, toast	Apple	Fish, chapati, vegetables	Yoghurt	Beans, rice, salad
Sat	Wholegrain porridge, milk	Dates, a few nuts	Daal, chapati, salad	Seasonal fruit	Chicken soup, toast
Sun	Scrambled egg, wholegrain toast	Orange	Vegetable rice, raita	Milk	Fish curry, chapati, vegetables

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Safe care reminder

• A designated healthy caregiver should follow current protective guidance, maintain ventilation and clean hands before and after contact. Do not share cups, towels or utensils unnecessarily; clean used items appropriately. The patient should rest and monitor symptoms, while emergency or worsening signs require immediate professional help. Current testing and return-to-activity decisions belong with health authorities, not a fixed historical timetable.

Original Exam-Practice MCQs

1. The play is primarily a satire on:

(a) materialism and hypocrisy (b) mountain conservation
(c) digital education (d) poetic ambition

Answer: (a) materialism and hypocrisy — The family's greed and performed grief are central.

2. Who first announces that Abel is getting up?

(a) Henry (b) Ben
(c) Victoria (d) Elizabeth

Answer: (c) Victoria — Victoria speaks the crucial truth.

3. Which object is moved downstairs before the Jordans arrive?

(a) a piano (b) a bureau
(c) a bed (d) a sofa

Answer: (b) a bureau — The bureau and clock are moved.

4. The new will initially makes the sisters:

(a) ignore Abel (b) compete to offer him a home
(c) leave immediately (d) burn the bureau

Answer: (b) compete to offer him a home — Their concern changes when inheritance is linked to care.

5. Abel plans to marry:

(a) Mrs. Parker (b) Mrs. John Shorrocks
(c) Dr. Pringle's sister (d) Mrs. Tattersall

Answer: (b) Mrs. John Shorrocks — She keeps the Ring-o'-Bells.

6. "Impassive" means:

(a) showing little emotion (b) speaking quickly
(c) extremely greedy (d) physically weak

Answer: (a) showing little emotion — It describes an unreadable expression.

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7. “Precocious” is closest in meaning to:

(a) advanced for one’s age (b) belated
(c) uncaring (d) shabby

Answer: (a) advanced for one’s age — It can describe unusually early development.

8. Which indirect form is correct?

(a) He said he has finished yesterday (b) He said that he had finished the previous day
(c) He said he will finished tomorrow (d) He said I am tired now

Answer: (b) He said that he had finished the previous day — Past reporting and time reference are adjusted.

9. A universal truth in reported speech normally:

(a) must become future tense (b) retains the present tense
(c) becomes a command (d) loses its verb

Answer: (b) retains the present tense — “The sun rises in the east” remains present.

10. Director’s notes are used to:

(a) show actions, movement and emotion (b) replace every spoken line
(c) identify rhymes (d) list dictionary meanings

Answer: (a) show actions, movement and emotion — They guide performance within the script.

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Points to Remember

Title irony: Abel has not departed, and most relatives do not treat him as dear.

Satire: comic contradictions expose greed, hypocrisy and performative respectability.

Plot: presumed death → property claims → Abel's return → new will and competition → independent exit.

Victoria provides truth and spontaneous affection; **Abel** converts discovery into agency.

Narration: adjust pronouns, tense, time references and reporting verbs; preserve universal truths.

Play script: character names + dialogue + punctuation + bracketed director's notes + clear setting.

Appendices: Review 2 and health exercises are included; period-specific medical instructions require current professional guidance.

MCQ key at a glance

Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key
1	a	2	c	3	b	4	b	5	b
6	a	7	a	8	b	9	b	10	a

How to attempt this unit in the paper

- For character questions, connect motive with stage action as well as dialogue.
- For satire, identify the gap between respectable appearance and selfish conduct.
- For narration, first identify statement, question, command, request, advice or exclamation.
- For script writing, keep director's notes brief and do not confuse them with spoken lines.
- For health content, separate the printed exercise from current clinical rules and flag emergency symptoms responsibly.